
Project Initiation & Planning

Project Charter & Statement of Work

- The project charter is a document that outlines the primary project objectives and assigns roles and responsibilities.
- The project charter helps the involved project managers and the stakeholders understand what the given project is supposed to accomplish.
- It defines the project's scope, offers deadlines and milestones, and provides information on identified risks and the budget.
- This document remains with you throughout the project's life cycle. You'll be referring to it throughout, whether at meetings or to assist with scope management. The charter acts as a roadmap.
- A project manager typically writes the project charter, however, it requires collaboration with different stakeholders to be a success

Project Charter & Statement of Work

Statement of Work

- A detailed **contract-style document** that describes exactly what work will be performed and how deliverables will be produced.
- SoW is a purely technical document prepared by the vendor, outlining the technical solution and the services the vendor is going to build or provide in a project.
- SoW is used externally by the company.

Differences between Project Charter and SoW

<u>Aspect</u>	<u>Project Charter</u>	<u>Statement of Work (SOW)</u>
Level of Detail	High-level, summary	Very detailed, technical, and contractual
Prepared by	Project sponsor/initiator	Client (buyer) or jointly with the vendor
Focus	Why the project is done, who is involved	What will be delivered, how, when, and under what conditions
Formality	Internal project authorization	Often contractual (can be legally binding)
Timing	Created at project initiation	Created before execution or contracting

Statement of work

By [Contractor Company Name]

For [Client Company Name]

Date

SOW #000

How to Write a Project Charter: Key Elements of a Project Charter

The project charter typically documents the following parts of the project:

- State the Project Information
- Project objectives and constraints
- Key stakeholders
- Risks identified
- Benefits of the project
- General overview of the budget
- Success metrics

State the Project Information

This first section in your project charter is where you'll include your project's general information, such as:

- Name,
- Description
- Project sponsor
- Project manager
- Team members, and
- Stakeholders

Project objectives and constraints

- **Outline the main objectives of the project.**

These objectives should be [SMART](#):

- Specific
- Measurable
- Achievable
- Realistic, and
- Time-bound.

- **Identify the constraints:**

- **Budget:** Limited financial resources
- **Time:** Deadlines and milestones
- **Resources:** Availability of skilled team members, tools, or technology
- **Stakeholder Requirements:** Changing or conflicting expectations
- **Scope Limitations:** Boundaries of what is included/excluded
- **Regulatory/Compliance Issues:** Legal and policy constraints

Project Timeline & Milestones

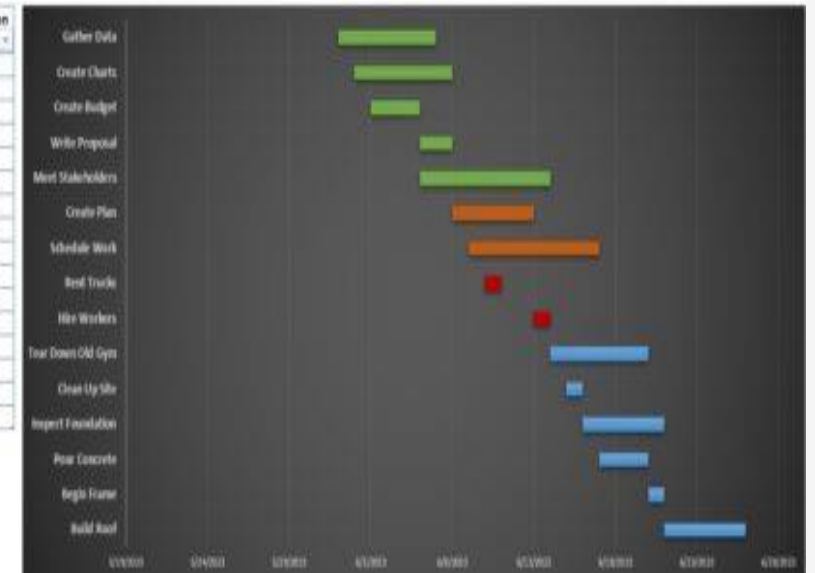
- **Define Start & End Dates**
 - Establish official project kickoff date
 - Set project completion deadline
- **Identify Key Milestones**
 - Major deliverables and checkpoints
 - Examples: Requirements finalized, Prototype completed, Testing phase start, Go-live date
- **Breakdown Activities**
 - Divide the project into phases and tasks
 - Assign estimated durations for each task
- **Create a Timeline**
 - Use Gantt charts or milestone charts
 - Show dependencies between tasks
- **Dynamic Tracking**
 - Input timeline into project management software (e.g., MS Project, Jira, Trello)
 - Update progress in real-time to monitor delays and bottlenecks

Project Timeline Template

Project Name:



Task Name	Start (Date)	End (Date)	Duration (Days)
Gather Data	6/1/2023	6/7/2023	6
Create Charts	6/2/2023	6/8/2023	6
Create Budget	6/3/2023	6/8/2023	5
Write Proposal	6/6/2023	6/8/2023	2
Meet Stakeholders	6/6/2023	6/14/2023	8
Create Plan	6/8/2023	6/13/2023	5
Schedule Work	6/9/2023	6/17/2023	8
Rent Trucks	6/10/2023	6/11/2023	1
Hire Workers	6/13/2023	6/14/2023	1
Tear Down Old Gym	6/14/2023	6/20/2023	6
Clean Up Site	6/15/2023	6/16/2023	1
Inspect Foundation	6/16/2023	6/21/2023	5
Pour Concrete	6/17/2023	6/20/2023	3
Begin Frame	6/20/2023	6/21/2023	1
Build Roof	6/21/2023	6/26/2023	5



Key stakeholders

Identifying Stakeholders: Anyone who is affected by, involved in, or can influence the project's success.

List All Stakeholders:

- **Internal:** Project sponsor, project manager, development team, testers
- **External:** Customers, vendors, regulators, end-users

Define Roles & Responsibilities:

- Sponsor: Provides funding & overall support
- Project Manager: Oversees execution
- Team Members: Deliver tasks & outputs
- End-users: Provide requirements & feedback

Identify Needs from Stakeholders:

- Approvals, resources, requirements, expertise, feedback

Maintain Contact Information:

- Emails, phone numbers, communication channels (Slack, Teams, etc.)

Who are the stakeholders in a project?



Log Key Project Risks

Types of Risks:

- **Technical Risks:** System failures, integration issues
- **Resource Risks:** Limited staff, skill shortages, budget cuts
- **Schedule Risks:** Delays, scope creep, unrealistic deadlines
- **Stakeholder Risks:** Changing requirements, low engagement
- **External Risks:** Regulatory changes, vendor delays, market shifts

Risk Management Plan :

- **Identify:** List potential risks early
- **Analyze:** Assess probability and impact
- **Respond:** Avoid, mitigate, transfer, or accept risk
- **Monitor:** Continuously track risks and update the plan

Benefits of the project

Consider and describe how the project will positively impact:

- Stakeholders
- Customers.
- End users

Be as specific as possible, as it's important to keep the benefits in mind as you work through the project to prioritize effectively

General overview of the budget

According to PMI, **Project management costs 7–11%** of the total project budget

High-Level Financial Overview

Available Funds: Total approved budget

Anticipated Costs Breakdown:

- **Project Management (7–11%)** – planning, monitoring, reporting
- **Human Resources** – salaries, training, consultants
- **Technology & Tools** – software licenses, hardware
- **Operations** – facilities, utilities, travel, communication
- **Quality Assurance & Testing** – validation, audits
- **Risk Reserves** – contingency funds for unforeseen issues

Success Metrics

- Success metrics provide measurable targets for project outcomes
- Support performance monitoring and evaluation

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

- On-time delivery of milestones
- Staying within budget limits
- Meeting quality standards (e.g., defect rates, compliance levels)
- Customer/end-user satisfaction levels
- Stakeholder engagement and approval

Other Metrics:

- Team productivity and efficiency
- Risk management effectiveness (resolved vs. open risks)
- ROI (Return on Investment) or the business value achieved

Sample Project Charter for Website Development

Project Title: University Website Redesign

Project Purpose:

Redesign and develop the university website to improve user experience, accessibility, and responsiveness, while modernizing content management for staff.

Project Objectives (SMART):

- **Specific:** Develop a responsive, accessible, and user-friendly website
- **Measurable:** Achieve 95% user satisfaction in usability surveys
- **Achievable:** Utilize existing IT team and CMS platform
- **Relevant:** Supports university branding and digital presence
- **Time-bound:** Complete redesign within 4 months

Scope:

- **In Scope:** Homepage redesign, faculty pages, news & events, student portal integration, content migration, responsive design
- **Out of Scope:** Third-party portal integration beyond the student portal, internal HR systems

Deliverables:

- Fully functional website with modern UI/UX
- Content migration from old website
- Documentation & training for content management
- Final project report

High-Level Timeline & Milestones:

- Requirements Gathering: Month 1
- Design & Prototyping: Month 1–2
- Development & CMS Setup: Month 2–3
- Testing & QA: Month 3
- Deployment & Training: Month 4

Estimated Budget:

Total: \$40,000 (design, development, content migration, testing, training, contingency)

Sample Project Charter for Website Development (cont..)

Project Team Members & Roles:

- **Project Manager:** Web Project Lead – oversees execution, scheduling, and resources
- **Lead Developer:** Senior web developer – supervises coding and integration
- **Front-end Developers:** 2 members – build UI and responsive design
- **Back-end Developers:** 2 members – implement server-side functionality
- **UI/UX Designer:** 1 member – create design mockups and prototypes
- **QA/Testers:** 2 members – functional, performance, and accessibility testing
- **Content Specialist:** 1 member – content migration and review
- **Support Staff:** 1 member – documentation, training, and coordination
- **End-users:** Students, faculty, staff – provide feedback and accept deliverables

Constraints:

- Budget limited to \$40,000
- Completion within 4 months
- Limited availability of senior web designers

Assumptions:

- Content will be provided on time by department heads
- Hosting and domain services will be maintained during project

Success Metrics:

- 95% user satisfaction in usability surveys
- Completion of website within project timeline and budget
- Zero critical defects at deployment
- At least 90% content migrated correctly
- Positive stakeholder feedback post-launch

Approval Signatures:

Project Sponsor: _____

Project Manager: _____

Date: _____

Quizzes

- A vendor is contracted to supply and install solar panels for a university campus. The document includes site details, technical specifications of the panels, warranty information, and payment terms.
- A new software project has just been approved. The sponsor has asked for a document that identifies the project manager, objectives, high-level scope, and success criteria. Which document is this?
- Your team is preparing a contract with an external vendor. The vendor wants clear details on project deliverables, payment terms, schedule, and acceptance conditions. Which document is required?
- A government agency is launching a new project to digitize land records. The project sponsor requests a document that states the project's purpose, names the project manager, and lists the major stakeholders. Which document is required?
- Before project execution, the steering committee wants to see a document that shows who the sponsor is, what problem the project will solve, and the estimated high-level budget.

Assignment

Jira is a popular project management and issue-tracking tool. It is widely used in software development, especially in Agile environments, to plan, track, and manage projects efficiently.

Task 1: Explore **Jira** Basics

Task 2: Create a Sample Project

- Create a new project (Scrum or Kanban).
- Add at least 5 tasks/issues, assigning them to team members (can be fictional).
- Set priorities (High, Medium, Low) and due dates.
- Add descriptions for each task, defining acceptance criteria.

Task 3: Organize and Track Work

- Create a sprint (if Scrum) or organize tasks on a Kanban board.
- Move tasks through stages (To Do → In Progress → Done).
- Monitor progress using Jira reports (Burndown chart, Sprint report, etc.).